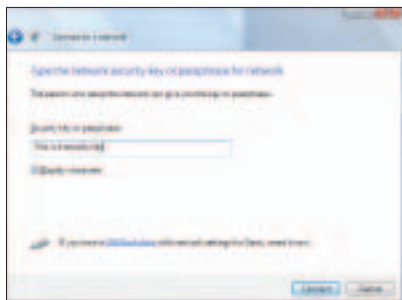
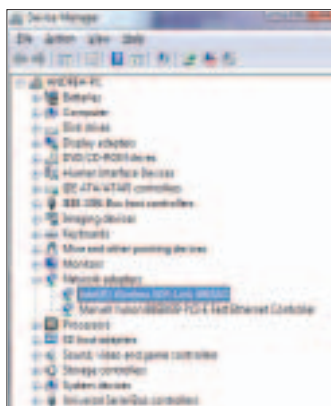


Step 4

If you can't find the right name in the list of available wireless networks, it may be that the one to which you're trying to connect has been hidden to prevent unauthorised access. To get to it, select Unnamed Network from the list and click Connect. You will be prompted to type the name of the network — get this from the owner of the network. Windows will then try to connect — if you need a passphrase or security key to access it, you'll be prompted for that. Type it in and click Connect. A common problem here is mistyping of keys — tick the 'Display characters' box to be able to see what you're typing, or copy and paste it from an email or text document.

Step 5

If Windows can't find any networks and your wireless facility is switched on (see introduction), check that the hardware is working. Click Start, then Control Panel, then Network and Sharing Center, then Manage Wireless Connections. Right-click the wireless connection and select Enable. If that doesn't work, click Start and type device, then click Device Manager when it appears above. In Device Manager, double-click Network Adapters to expand it, and look for your wireless network adapter. If it's not there, make sure it's physically connected. Check the fitting; if it's a USB device try it in another port. A yellow exclamation mark in Device Manager means it is not working — try installing the latest drivers from the maker's website. A red X means it has been disabled — right-click it and select Enable.

**Step 6**

Wireless networks can work over a number of 'channels'. You can set the channel when you set up the network (on your router or wireless access point). If you live in a city with lots of wireless networks around you, choose a channel few others are using to minimise interference. Log in to your router (instructions vary between manufacturers) and choose another channel for the wireless connection (you'll need to reconnect any computers connected to it) and see if performance improves. The placement of the wireless router is also important. If it has 'line of sight' to the computer you'll get a better signal; if not, try to place it so there are fewer obstacles in the way.